

Role Models UOI – Lesson 1 (A & B): What is a role model?

Lesson flow + materials request for design team · Level 5 (G3) · Literacy

Theme	Who We Are
Central idea	Choices of role models reflect the beliefs and values of individuals and societies.
Line of inquiry	How and why role models are chosen
Lesson objectives	Students will be able to: • explain what a role model is in their own words • describe a character's traits and how their actions affect the story • sort traits into positive and negative role-model traits
Standards	RL.3.2, RL.3.3, L.3.1.A, W.3.1
Assessment	T-chart of good / not good role-model traits (end of Lesson 1-B)

Lesson flow – 1A

Key: "quotes" = teacher says · [brackets] = teacher does / on screen

Step	Teacher script	Students / material
Welcome	"Hello, everyone! Welcome to our new unit. For the next few weeks we're going to be thinking about people we look up to, and why. Before we start, I want to get to know you a little better, and I want you to get to know each other." [Show unit title slide, then lesson goal slide.] "Today's goal is to find out what a role model is. By the end of our lesson, you'll be able to tell me what a role model would do, and what a role model would not do."	Students: Listen; read the lesson goal with the teacher. Material: Title + goal slides
Tuning in	[Show M1 game board.] "Let's play a game! I'll roll the dice and move my piece first, so you can see how it works." [Click M2, roll, move to the space.] "I landed on 'What is your favorite food?' My favorite food is dumplings, because my friends and I make them together. Now it's your turn. Roll the dice, read your question, and answer in a full sentence: 'My favorite ____ is ____ because ____.'" [Each student takes 1–2 turns. Write the sentence frame on the board.] "Great answers! I noticed some of you have the same favorite things. We already learned something about each other."	Students: Take turns rolling, reading the question, and answering with the sentence frame. Material: M1, M2

Finding out	"Have you ever heard the words 'role model'? Turn and tell me what you think it means." [Take 2–3 answers. Show definition slide.] "A role model is a person we look up to. We want to be like them because of the way they act and the choices they make. A role model can be famous, but it can also be someone in your family, a teacher, or a friend." [Show M3 sort.] "Here are some words that describe how people act. Let's decide together: would a role model act this way, or not? I'll do the first one. 'Honest.' Honest means telling the truth. I think a role model would be honest, because we can trust them. So I'll put 'honest' in the 'would' box. Now you try 'selfish.' Selfish means only thinking about yourself. Would a role model be selfish? Why or why not?" [Students sort the remaining cards. Ask 'Why?' for at least two cards.]	Students: Share ideas about 'role model'; sort the trait cards and explain their reasons. Material: Definition slide, M3
Going further	"Now let's hear from some young people about who they look up to. Listen for two things: who their role model is, and why they chose that person." [Play M4 video, opening section only. Pause.] "What did you hear? Who did they choose? Why?" [Show question slide.] "Now think about you. Who do you look up to? It could be someone in your family, a teacher, an athlete, anyone. Finish this sentence: 'I look up to ____ because ____.'"	Students: Listen for who and why; share their own role model with the sentence frame. Material: M4
Closing	"Today you learned that a role model is someone we look up to because of how they act. You also sorted traits a role model would and would not have. Next time, we'll read a story about a monkey and a crocodile and decide if either one would make a good role model. See you then!"	Students: Repeat the definition of a role model. Material: —

Lesson flow – 1B

Step	Teacher script	Students / material
Review	"Welcome back! Last time we learned what a role model is. Who can remember? A role model is..." [Pause for answers. Show M3 sort from 1A.] "Look at the cards we sorted. Tell me one trait a role model would have, and one they would not."	Students: Recall the definition and one trait from each side of the sort. Material: M3

Before reading	[Show M5 cover.] "Today's story is a fable. A fable is a short story, often with animals, that teaches us a lesson. This one is called The Monkey and the Crocodile. Look at the picture. What do you think will happen between these two animals?" [Take 2–3 predictions.] "As we read, be a detective. Watch how each animal acts and what choices they make."	Students: Make predictions about the story. Material: M5
Reading	[Read M5 page by page. Stop at each pause icon.] "Pause point 1: The Monkey and the Crocodile are becoming friends. How is the Monkey acting? What word from our sort describes him?" "Pause point 2: Now the Crocodile asks the Monkey to come with him. How is the Crocodile acting here? Is he being honest?" "Pause point 3: The Monkey has to think fast. What does that tell us about him?"	Students: Answer questions at each pause point, using trait words from the sort. Material: M5
Sorting out	[Show M6 character cards.] "Let's collect evidence. On each character card, write three traits for that animal. I'll start the Monkey's card with you. At the beginning, he shared his fruit with the Crocodile, so I'll write 'kind.' Now you add two more for the Monkey, and three for the Crocodile. Remember to think about what they did in the story."	Students: Complete a character card for each animal, with three traits each. Material: M6
Reflecting	[Show M7 T-chart.] "Now let's use our cards. Put each trait in the right column: good role-model traits on one side, and not role-model traits on the other." [Students drag traits into the T-chart.] "Look at our T-chart. Which animal would you choose as a role model? Tell me why, using a trait from the chart: 'I would choose ___ because ___.'"	Students: Complete the T-chart; give an opinion with a reason. Material: M7 (assessment)
Closing	"Today you used evidence from a story to decide what makes a good role model. In our next lesson, we'll look at the traits role models share. Great work today!"	Students: — Material: —

Materials request

M1 – Get-to-know-you board game	NEW – please design
On-screen game board. One question per space (favorite food, hobby, place you want to visit, etc.). Adapt from the activity pack in the L1-A folder; don't copy the pack's artwork.	

M2 – Dice roller

EXISTING – link only

Use the online dice roller (link in planner). Add a button on the game slide that opens it.

M3 – Role model attribute sort

NEW – please design

Trait word cards with a simple picture each, and two bins students drag cards into. Mix of positive and negative traits.

[kind] [honest] [brave] [helpful]
[rude] [selfish] [unfair] [lazy]

+-----+	+-----+
A role model WOULD	A role model WOULD NOT
+-----+	+-----+

Reuse this sort in the 1B review.

M4 – Video + question slide

EXISTING video – link only; NEW slide

- "What Teens Think About Role Models" (YouTube, link in planner). Play the opening section only, then pause.
- Slide after the video: "Who do you look up to? Why?"

M5 – Reader: The Monkey and the Crocodile

EXISTING – licensed reader, use as is

Leveled reader from the L1-B folder, shown page by page. Add a small pause icon on the pages where the teacher stops to ask questions.

M6 – Character cards

NEW – please design

+-----+	+-----+
[picture]	[picture]
MONKEY	CROCODILE
trait: _____	trait: _____
trait: _____	trait: _____
trait: _____	trait: _____
+-----+	+-----+

M7 – T-chart (assessment)

NEW – please design

+-----+	+-----+
Good role-model traits	Not role-model traits
+-----+	+-----+
+-----+	+-----+

Need both versions: on-screen (drag traits in) and printable. Same template will be used again later in the unit.

Notes for the team

- Keep text on screen still while students are reading.
- Use the same pause icon every time the teacher stops for discussion.
- Please send drafts of M1, M3, M6, and M7 for review before recording.